



# GDD 11

## Not Fair, Not Funny

**A joke shouldn't hurt**

The gender-teasing and ally game for ages 6-9, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard. Children tell fun teasing from mean, see through "just a joke", call out gender put-downs, and practise the upstander moves. Eight mechanics, thirty-three real-choice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

# A joke shouldn't hurt.

Not Fair, Not Funny is the gender-teasing and ally game: children learn to tell fun teasing from mean, see through the "just a joke" dodge, recognise and refuse gender put-downs ("you throw like a girl", "boys don't cry", "that's so girly"), and practise the moves that turn a bystander into an upstander. It builds on Fair Play World (g10) and is a key Gender & Respect node (UNESCO 3.3). New v2 build to the persona-and-research standard.

| FIELD                    | VALUE                                                                  |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Node / gameld            | g11 · <b>not-fair-not-funny</b> (confirm exact id against engine-host) |
| Chapter / ages           | Chapter 2 · ages 6-9 · light canvas · solo or peer                     |
| Thread / topics          | E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.3                                      |
| Prerequisite / builds on | g10 (Fair Play World)                                                  |
| Gating                   | Core                                                                   |
| Schema / status          | <b>v2 · scorecard PASS</b> new build to the standard.                  |

**84**

scenarios

**8**

mechanics

**33**

real-choice moves

**15**

myths busted

**0%**

binary taps

# The teased, the ally, the joker.

From the Chapter 2 personas. The game serves the kid on the receiving end, the kid who can stand up, and the kid who needs to check their own jokes.

| PERSONA                            | WHAT THEY NEED HERE                             | THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT                                                |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Faizan"-type (teased as "girly")  | To know it's not his fault, and how to respond. | <b>strike-rewrite + branch</b> : "'girly' isn't an insult"; self-advocacy. |
| Ananya, 8 (justice-seeker, anchor) | The words and moves to be an ally.              | <b>branch + role-play</b> : upstander moves; "not funny".                  |
| Reyansh, 7 (repeats peer jokes)    | To check his own jokes and repair.              | <b>reflect + branch</b> : punch up not down; apologise.                    |
| A quieter, shy child               | Low-risk ways to help.                          | <b>branch</b> : distract, support, tell, quiet allyship.                   |
| Sana / parents                     | Kids who back each other up.                    | Ally framing throughout; check-in-after moves.                             |

**Why this works (the evidence).** "Disparagement humor" ("just a joke") normalises prejudice and can be as harmful as hate speech, sexist jokes even raise acceptance of devaluing women. And peer upstanders stop bullying within 10 seconds more than half the time, so the highest-leverage skill is teaching kids the ally moves and the confidence to use them.

## Eight moves, one rule: jokes don't hurt.

The rework's heart: the lesson arrives through eight actions, led by deciding real moments and rehearsing what to say. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

| MECHANIC                   | THE CHILD DOES                                                  | EMBODIES                                 | N  |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>branch</b><br>(dilemma) | Decides the kind/ally move in a real teasing moment.            | Upstander decisions; impact over intent. | 24 |
| <b>reflect</b>             | Checks how a joke lands, and their own jokes (no wrong answer). | Empathy; self-awareness.                 | 22 |
| <b>strike-rewrite</b>      | Erases a "just a joke" / gender-insult myth.                    | Conceptual change.                       | 15 |
| <b>role-play</b> (voice)   | Says the comeback / ally line ("not funny").                    | Assertion; upstanding.                   | 9  |
| <b>sort</b>                | Fun vs mean; joke vs put-down.                                  | Telling them apart.                      | 7  |
| <b>spot</b>                | Finds the put-down dressed as a joke.                           | Recognising disguised harm.              | 3  |
| <b>build</b>               | Builds an ally toolkit / "kind comedian" code.                  | Ready-to-use moves.                      | 3  |
| <b>match</b>               | Pairs a put-down to the feeling it causes.                      | Impact awareness.                        | 1  |

**33 of 84** moments are branch or role-play, allyship is decided and rehearsed. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

# The two-test, passed.

## Is it fun?

It's lively and a little cheeky: you judge real "is this fun or mean?" calls, deliver the satisfying comeback, flip a pile-on into kindness, and discover you can be the funniest and the kindest kid in the room. The dilemmas are recognisable playground moments with real social stakes, and the upstander "win" feels genuinely good.

## Is it teaching?

Yes, the gender-teasing and allyship curriculum: fun vs mean teasing, why "just a joke" doesn't erase harm (impact over intent), recognising gender and appearance put-downs, and the concrete upstander moves, speak up, distract, support, tell, check in after, plus checking your own jokes.

**The belief it moves.** From "it's just a joke; 'like a girl' is an insult; if it's not happening to me it's not my problem; you have to roast someone to be funny" → "a joke that hurts isn't funny, gender isn't an insult, standing up is my business, and the best humor needs no victim."

## Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across six categories, India-aware (gendered & colourist jabs, "roasting" culture) and impact-over-intent throughout. Full library in the companion JSON.

| CATEGORY                    | N  | LEAD MECHANICS                    | COVERS                                                             |
|-----------------------------|----|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fun teasing vs mean teasing | 8  | sort, branch, spot                | Both laugh & stops when asked vs aims to hurt & keeps going.       |
| "Just a joke" isn't a pass  | 9  | strike-rewrite, branch            | Put-downs hurt even labelled jokes; "can't take a joke" dodge.     |
| Gender teasing & put-downs  | 14 | strike-rewrite, branch, role-play | "Like a girl", "boys don't cry", "so girly", "bossy", looks/skin.  |
| How put-downs feel          | 10 | reflect, branch, match            | Impact over intent; apologise; check in after; behind-the-back.    |
| Being an ally (upstander)   | 18 | branch, role-play, build          | Speak up, distract, support, tell; quiet allyship; bring backup.   |
| Checking my own jokes       | 14 | reflect, branch, build            | Punch up not down; joke with not at; repair; "kind comedian" code. |

### A branch scenario (upstander), verbatim.

hook: "A friend is being teased about their gender right in front of you."  
 option A "Speak up: 'that's not kind, stop'" -> the teasing often stops fast [best]  
 option B "Look away" -> silence lets it continue  
 debrief: "When a peer steps in, teasing often stops within seconds."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 11 Not Fair Not Funny — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

# What this game erases.

| MYTH (UN ERASES)                                             | TRUTH (RE WRITES)                                       | BASIS                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <del>If you call it a joke, it can't really hurt.</del>      | "Just a joke" doesn't erase the hurt; the harm is real. | Disparagement humor. |
| <del>Not laughing means you can't take a joke.</del>         | Not laughing means you noticed it wasn't kind.          | Disparagement humor. |
| <del>"Like a girl" is an insult.</del>                       | Girls are great at everything; it's not a put-down.     | Gender teasing.      |
| <del>"That's so girly" shames a boy.</del>                   | "Girly" isn't an insult; anyone can like anything.      | Gender norms.        |
| <del>Teasing a boy for crying is fine.</del>                 | Everyone cries; it's not a put-down.                    | Gender teasing.      |
| <del>If I didn't mean to hurt, it doesn't count.</del>       | Hurt counts even when unmeant; you can make it right.   | Impact over intent.  |
| <del>If it's not happening to me, it's not my problem.</del> | An ally who steps in can stop it; silence lets it grow. | Bystander research.  |
| <del>You have to put someone down to be funny.</del>         | The funniest jokes need no victim.                      | Inclusive humor.     |
| <del>Teasing toughens kids up.</del>                         | Mean teasing wears kids down; support builds strength.  | Child wellbeing.     |

## The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "is this one fun... or not fair, not funny?".
2. **Play.** One of eight mechanics, led by a real teasing moment, rotated.
3. **Ripple.** A branch choice shows what your move does, with a debrief, no buzzer.
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("just a joke" → "the hurt is real").
5. **Apply.** Say the comeback, build your ally toolkit, or check in on a friend.
6. **Sticker.** The upstander badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surfaces: the **fun-or-mean meter**, the **say-the-line** comeback/ally rehearsal, and the **ally toolkit** builder. Pairs tightly with Fair Play World (g10) and Friend or Frenemy (g09).

## Light touch, real spine.

- **Register.** Ages 6-9, never babyish or preachy; playful and a bit cheeky, with a real spine of kindness.
- **Impact over intent.** The game centres how a joke lands, not whether the teller "meant it", without shaming kids who slip.
- **Don't villainise the joker.** Reyansh-type kids are invited to check and repair, not branded "bad"; humor itself is celebrated.
- **Protect the target.** The teased child is never made to feel at fault; self-advocacy and support are modelled.
- **Safe escalation.** When peer moves aren't enough, telling a trusted adult is framed as reporting, not tattling.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded jabs handled with care; pairs with the gender thread.

## v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. not-fair-not-funny** — `node.game === GameDone` key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. Each scenario carries type + typed payload (`branch.options`, `strike-rewrite.myth`, `role-play.yourLine`, `sort.items/bins/key`, `spot.scene`, `build.pieces`, `match.pairs`, `reflect.options`). Reuses the shared templates from g09.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (8 mechanics, max 29%, 0% binary, 33 autonomy, 15 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Cross-links**. Builds on g10; shares the ally/bystander frame with Friend or Frenemy (g09) and feeds Ch.3 Stand Up (g27).
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the `xlsx` + `gen-path`, never hand-edited `path.ts`.

**Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement):** impact over intent; don't villainise the joker; protect the target; reporting not tattling; celebrate kind humor; made-for-India.

## Why this works.

- **"Just a joke" is not harmless.** Disparagement humor normalises prejudice and reinforces hierarchies, and can be as harmful as hate speech; exposure to sexist jokes raises acceptance of devaluing women, so the game teaches kids to see through the "joke" cover.
- **Upstanders work, fast.** When a peer steps in, bullying stops within 10 seconds over half the time, and peer-supported targets are less anxious and depressed, so the ally moves (speak up, distract, support, tell, check in) are the highest-leverage content.
- **Impact over intent.** What matters is how a joke lands, not whether it was "meant", a teachable, repair-friendly frame that helps the joker grow without shame and protects the target.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 12 games now v2. Next in Chapter 2: Smart Screen Heroes (g12), then Heart Smart (g41), which completes Chapter 2.